

Διογένης ὁ Λαέρτιος

Lives and Epigrams by Diogenes Laertius

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Period: *Ῥωμαϊκή* [Roman](#)
Dialect: *Ἀττικίζουσα* [Atticizing](#)
Domain: *Βίος* [Biography](#)
Format: *Ἑμμετρος* [Verse](#)

Diogenes Laertius was a biographer of Greek philosophers, likely active in the first half of the 3rd century CE. His name suggests origins in Laerte in Cilicia or Crete, though this remains uncertain. He dedicated his major work to a woman interested in Plato, indicating he moved within educated circles.

His extant work is the *Lives and Opinions of Eminent Philosophers*, a ten-book compilation. He also wrote the *Pammetros*, a lost collection of poems by philosophers. Diogenes Laertius is a principal source for the history of ancient Greek philosophy. His compilation preserves biographies, doctrines, and anecdotes for over eighty philosophers, drawing from many now-lost sources.

While criticized for a lack of critical analysis, his work is indispensable, especially for understanding Hellenistic schools like the Epicureans, whose three surviving letters he alone preserved.

Works (11)

- *Ἐπιγράμματα* · [Epigrams](#) · 153 passages
- *Βίοι καὶ γνῶμαι τῶν ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ εὐδοκιμησάντων, Α΄* · [Lives and Opinions: Book I \(Seven Sages\)](#) · 122 passages
- *Βίοι καὶ γνῶμαι τῶν ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ εὐδοκιμησάντων, Β΄* · [Lives and Opinions: Book II \(Socratics\)](#) · 145 passages
- *Βίοι καὶ γνῶμαι τῶν ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ εὐδοκιμησάντων, Γ΄* · [Lives and Opinions: Book III \(Plato\)](#) · 109 passages
- *Βίοι καὶ γνῶμαι τῶν ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ εὐδοκιμησάντων, Δ΄* · [Lives and Opinions: Book IV \(Academy\)](#) · 64 passages
- *Βίοι καὶ γνῶμαι τῶν ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ εὐδοκιμησάντων, Θ΄* · [Lives and Opinions: Book IX \(Atomists and Sceptics\)](#) · 115 passages
- *Βίοι καὶ γνῶμαι τῶν ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ εὐδοκιμησάντων, Ε΄* · [Lives and Opinions: Book V \(Peripatetics\)](#) · 79 passages
- *Βίοι καὶ γνῶμαι τῶν ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ εὐδοκιμησάντων, ΣΤ΄* · [Lives and Opinions: Book VI \(Cynics\)](#) · 106 passages
- *Βίοι καὶ γνῶμαι τῶν ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ εὐδοκιμησάντων, Ζ΄* · [Lives and Opinions: Book VII \(The Stoics\)](#) · 199 passages
- *Βίοι καὶ γνῶμαι τῶν ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ εὐδοκιμησάντων, Η΄* · [Lives and Opinions: Book VIII \(Pythagoreans\)](#) · 92 passages
- *Βίοι καὶ γνῶμαι τῶν ἐν φιλοσοφίᾳ εὐδοκιμησάντων, Ι΄* · [Lives and Opinions: Book X \(Epicurus\)](#) · 151 passages